

Project “HELIOS”

Tower Defense Game

Main Concept paper

1. Main concept

HELIOS is supposed to be a strategic level-based game revolving mainly around tower defense. The main objective is to defend an ancient Mediterranean polis against attacks by foreign nations. Enemies attack by sea and air. The player has three defensive options at their disposal:

- The player can manipulate the ships' route by placing islands in their path.
- On the resulting islands, it is possible to build defensive towers and resource extraction centers (needed for upgrades).
- The player can deploy their own naval and aerial units.

The main goal is to beat next levels, defend the polis and upgrade your units

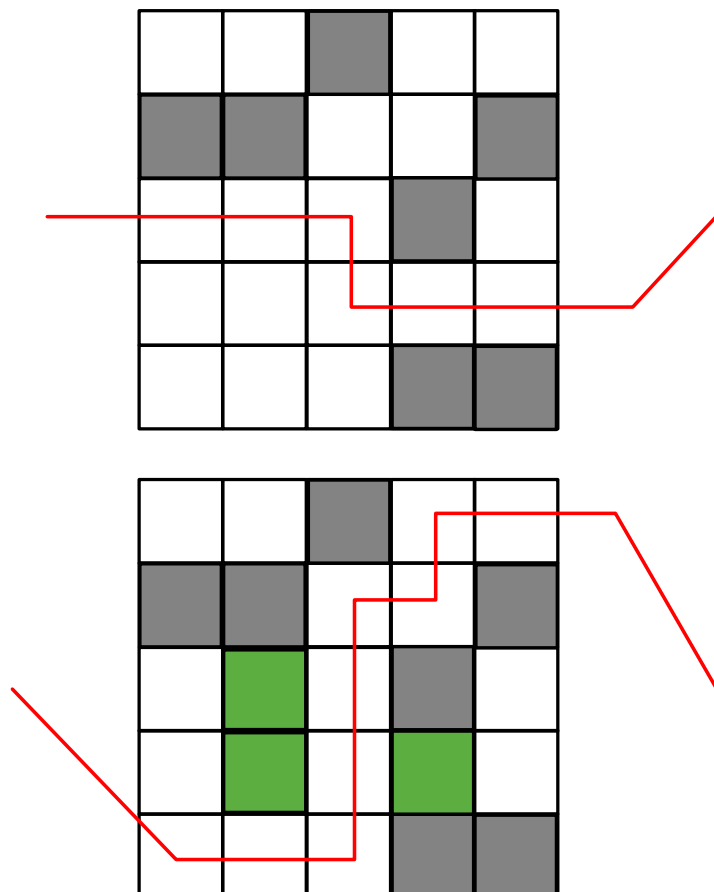
2. Gameplay loop

2.1. The battleground:

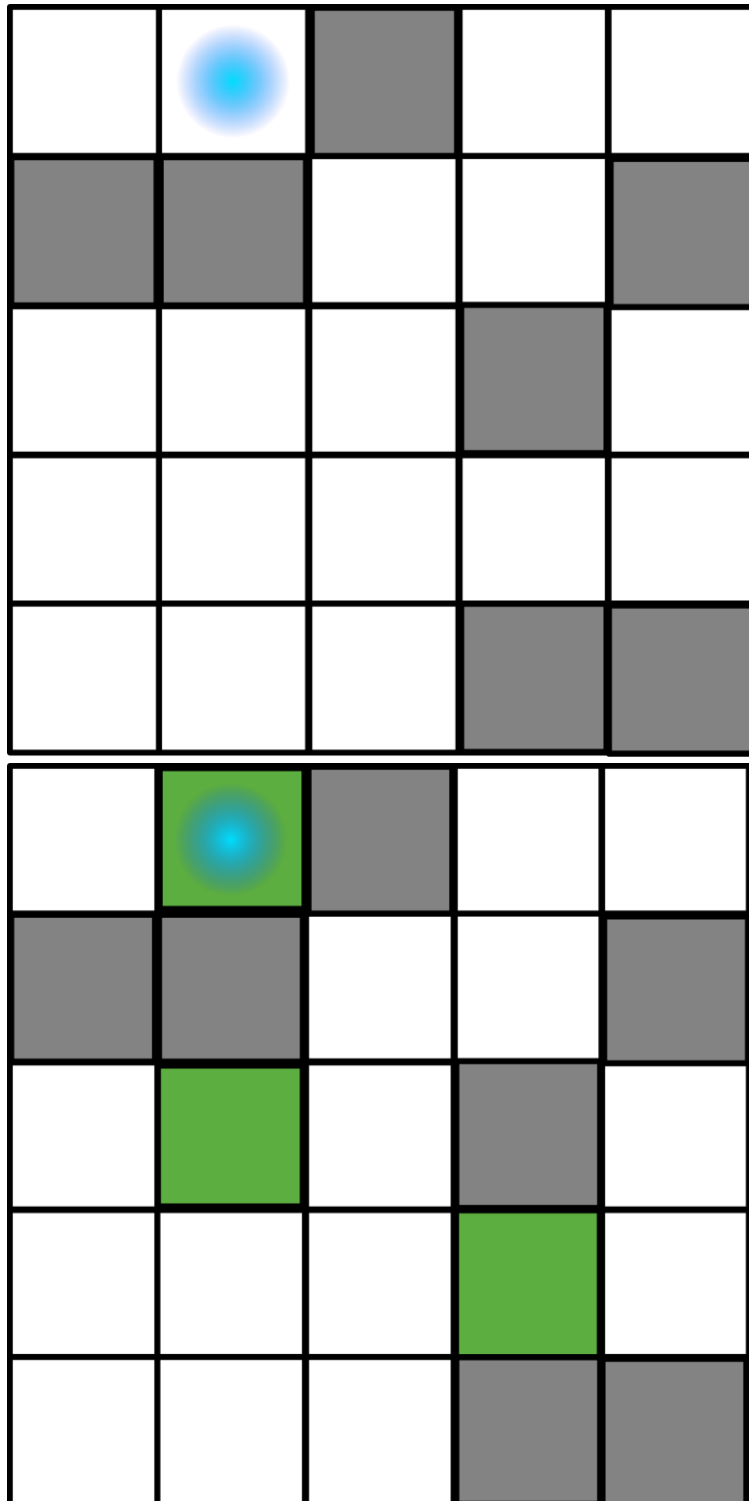
Whole battle takes place between the player side and the enemy side. In the center is the main board where units moves and towers can be placed. The goal of the player is to destroy the enemy base and gather resources. Resources on each level are limited per play, and the rewards are smaller after every clear.

2.1.1. Stage 1: Building islands

The main battlefield is a NxN board with some route already existing. Player starts each level with some amount of mana, that lets him build islands to alternate enemies route.



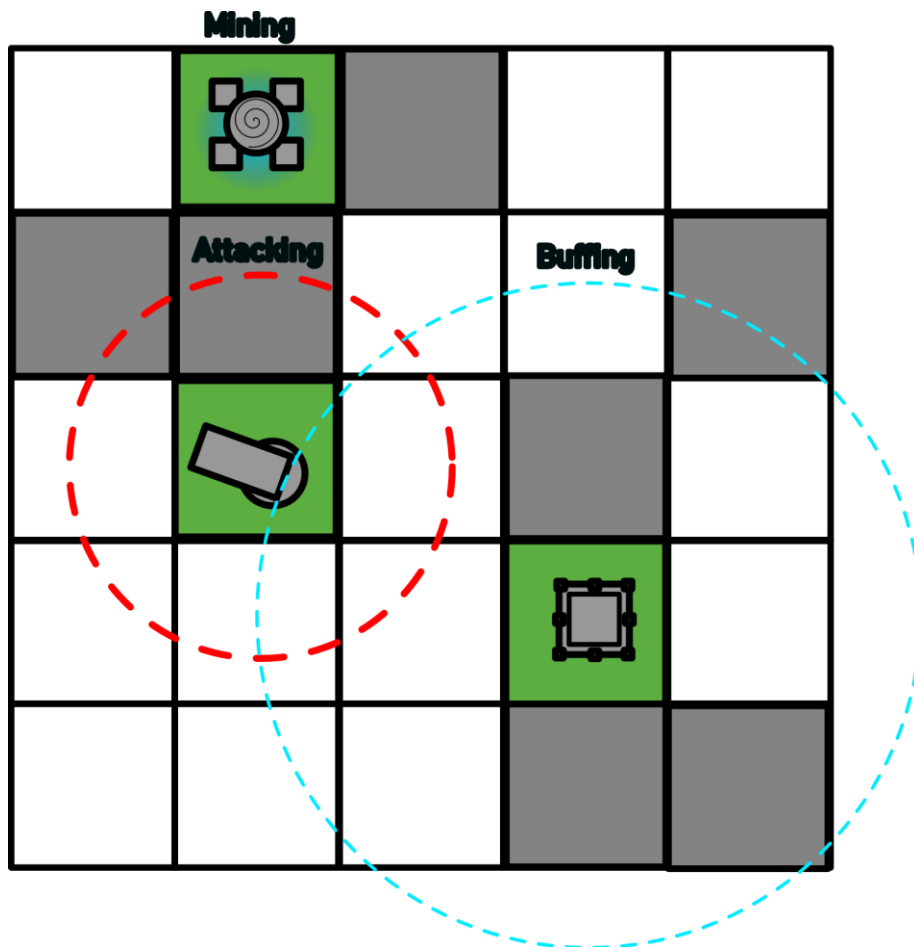
On some levels, there are “underwater sources” that contains materials used for upgrades. To gather these resources, player have to place an island there first.



2.1.2. Stage 2: Tower placing

When player is done placing islands, he can place towers on these islands. Player have a variety of towers to choose from. At first most of them are locked, but can be acquired by progressing the game. Each tower can be upgraded during the game. The maximum level is limited by the tower's upgrades unlocked between the battles. Towers can be one of the three types:

- Offensive – attacking enemy units
- Support - supporting placed units (buff units or debuff enemies)
- Collectors – used to collect resources from the sources.

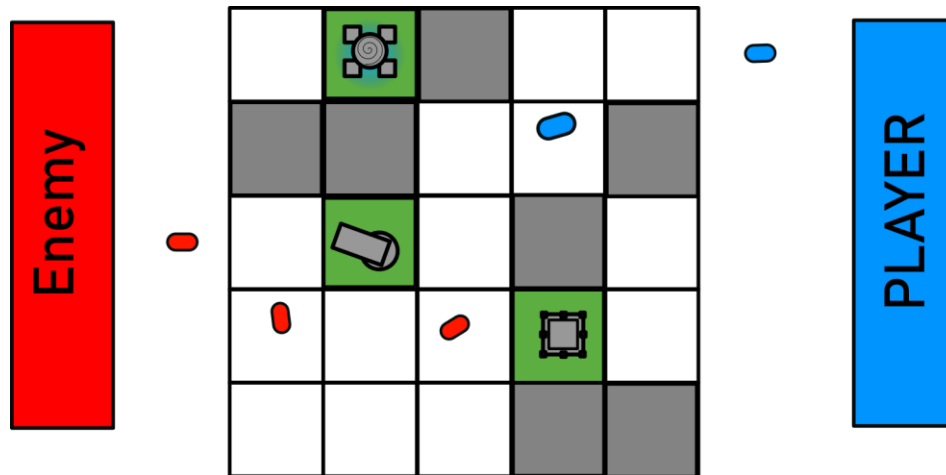


2.1.3. Stage 3: Enemy attacks

In this stage, the enemy units starts swarming the player's base. During the fight, player still can place and upgrade towers, but also can send his own units to attack the enemy.

Enemy spawn is triggered either by flow of time or by hitting the enemy base.

For example: Level have constant spawn of low level units every 3 seconds. At 30,60,120 seconds the bigger enemy spawns. After enemy base reach 60% health, the boss spawns.



The game is finished when one side, destroys the other's base.

2.1.4. Stage 4: returning to base

In the main hub, players can view their units and towers and upgrade them.

They can also manage their unit deck. This is also where players select their next campaign objective. Players also have access to a library of encountered opponents, and for every level the player has played at least once (and not necessarily completed successfully), a list of the opponents appearing in that level is available.

3. Towers, units and enemies

Each of the three—towers, player units, and enemy units—has its own traits and perks. Some types of towers or units will not be effective against other types.

The basic unit types are:

- Basic
- Flying
- Armed
- Magical

The basic tower types are:

- Basic
- Anti-Air
- Heavy
- Magical

Each unit and tower can have multiple types at the same time.

In addition to types, there are also perks:

- knockback
- freeze
- single target
- multiple targets
- target only

4. Further development and ideas:

Here are some ideas that could be implemented in the future:

4.1. Event campaigns

Game could have online mode with event campaigns available from time to time.

4.2. Gacha system

More towers could be obtained not only by completing the campaign but also by buying some lootboxes. Can also consider some premium currency and microtransactions.

5. Artstyle

5.1. The game uses a clean low-poly aesthetic with simplified geometry, emphasizing readability and clarity during gameplay

The environment draws heavily from Mediterranean landscapes, featuring bright coastal waters, sunlit stone structures, and scattered island formations.

The units and towers revolves around to main points: machinery and magic.

Some units are purely mechanical contraptions, containing a lot of gears, bronze and iron, many wooden elements.

Some other units are magical. They are made mostly of white stone, have a lot of elements resembling ancient Greek architecture.

There is also a group of units that combine both engineering and magic, creating big stone structures with wooden mechanical supports and glowing arcane energy.

5.2. The color palette contrasts warm, sunlit environments with vibrant magical effects.

The main colors of the environment are blue of the ocean, white and beige of the cliffs and green of the islands.

5.3. Each trait have its color code:

- Basic units are made mostly of wood and stone
- Armored and heavy units contain a lot of bronze and iron elements.
- Magic units are mostly made of stone and glowing magic energy.